

Christian Metal Band

By

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INT. REHEARSAL SPACE - DAY

Three band mates ready to play their instruments in a nice studio. PAULA, early-20s, punky, tunes her bass. MARK, late-20s, black-clad, tunes his drums. DEREK, early-20s, preppy and clean cut, sets up his mic stand. Derek anxiously checks his watch.

EDWARD, cute and grungy, suddenly walks in with his guitar bag. Derek shoots him the stink eye.

DEREK

Well look who finally showed up.

EDWARD

Sorry, guys. I overslept.

DEREK

Well I'll say! Now we have to wait for you to set up.

EDWARD

Sorry, man. I was out late with Amy last night.

DEREK

You were out late, even though you knew we had practice at 7am? Please tell me you two didn't engage in intercourse...

EDWARD

No. I mean... 7am is a little early for practice, don't you think?

DEREK

Not if you want to get the worm, silly bird! Edward, I don't mean to be harsh but sometimes I really question your devotion to God.

Easter social is this weekend, guys! Which means we have only three days to get our songs suitable for the ears of our lord. We gotta show Father Tillman our music is worthy of Jesus' glory. I didn't write these beautiful songs for our savior only to have them spoiled by a lazy lemon, Edward, pardon my french.

(CONTINUED)

EDWARD
Sorry dude, I just...

DEREK
What?

EDWARD
Nothing. Let's just play.

DEREK (CONT'D)
OK, great. Lets do a quick sound
check. We'll start with "Blood Of
Christ" Mark, count us in. Paula,
watch those 16th notes on the
bridge.

MARK
1 2 3 4.

The group break into a very heavy and fast death metal song.

CUT TO:

INT. DINER - DAY

The four sit at a booth eating lunch. Edward is busy
texting.

DEREK
I think we made some good headway
today, guys. A few more practices
and it will be-
(noticing Edward texting)
Edward, can you please wait until
after the band meeting to text Amy.

EDWARD
Sorry, Derek. Go ahead.

DEREK
Thank you. So as I was saying, I
can do a second session in the
afternoon tomorrow if I come
straight from choir practice.

MARK
I'm working the late shift
tomorrow.

DEREK
Ugh, can't you switch with someone?

(CONTINUED)

MARK

I already did...so I can make it to morning practice.

DEREK

Well we need as many sessions as we can get in before Sunday. Blood of Christ sounds OK but Lucifer's Bane needs more work. Whatever, we'll wait for you, Mark. Paula and Ed, you're good for a second session tomorrow, right?

EDWARD

Actually, I just made plans with Amy tomorrow night.

DEREK

(shocked)

What?!!! OK, band meeting!

PAULA

We're *already* having a band meeting.

DEREK

I was going to wait until after the big concert to say something but... Edward, we think you might be spending too much time with Amy. It's really getting in the way of the band.

EDWARD

Yeah, I was going to talk to you about that. We've been rehearsing 6 days a week. I hardly have any free time.

DEREK

Oh, I'm sorry. Did the lord have any free time during those six days when he made the entire world?! No, he didn't, did he?

EDWARD

Yeah, well... That probably didn't really happen, so...

DEREK

(incredulous glare)

Wow. I don't even know you are anymore.

(CONTINUED)

EDWARD

Honestly, dude. Amy and I watched this documentary... Did you know Jesus wasn't even born in December?

PAULA

Yeah, I read that online.

DEREK

I can't believe all the blasphemy I'm hearing right now. It's obvious Amy is a toxic influence that is destroying the band. I'm sorry to do this but I think we need to put our foot down...feet...all our feet down. Edward, you need to sever all contact with this girl, not just for the band, but for the sake of your soul.

EDWARD

Honestly, Derek. I'm not even sure I believe in God anymore.

DEREK

(shocked)

Well... I guess that settles it. Good luck, Edward. I'll be praying for you.

PAULA

Actually, I've been an atheist since high school.

DEREK

What?!!

EDWARD

Really? Why didn't you ever say anything?

PAULA

It never came up.

DEREK

Never came-- We're a Christian band!

MARK

Guys, I'm a straight-up satanist.

Mark lifts his shirt to show off the big pentagram tattoo on his chest.

(CONTINUED)

PAULA
Oh, nice ink, dude!

DEREK
Seriously?!

MARK
Yeah, man. I just joined the band
as a goof.

DEREK
For 4 years?!!

MARK
Yeah, well... I guess I just forgot
it was a joke. I mean, we play
death metal, man.

DEREK
Yes but it's death metal *for the*
lord. Sure Father Tillman might not
get it but God doesn't discriminate
when it comes to-- Ugh. Never mind.
So, what, you guys are not
Christians anymore?

EDWARD
I guess not.

PAULA
Nope.

MARK
Never was.

Derek hangs his head in despair.

EDWARD
Hey, If it makes any difference, I
still think the songs are good.

PHIL
Yeah, man.

DEREK
You guys really think so?

MARK
Hell yeah, dude. That's why I stuck
around.

(CONTINUED)

DEREK

But if we're not a Christian band
then what are we? All my lyrics are
about God.

EDWARD

Yeah. I also wanted to talk to you
about that. I'd never actually
listened to your lyrics until Amy
pointed them out to me. Like in
Jesus Hole, in the chorus, are you
saying "Take my innocence, by my
seat?"

DEREK

Haha! Of course not. I'm saying
"take my innocent tiny meat" It's
like, a metaphor. I'm talking about
my purity, like fresh ground beef
being pulverized so it can taste
better. You know?

EDWARD

Um, OK. What about in the end of
the second verse? Are you saying
"When father takes me to the altar,
I hope there's lube this time"??

DEREK

Oh yeah, that's like about when
you're resisting Christ's love and
the priest has to help you find
your center so you can rise above
the pain... It's the whole premise
of the song, guys.

PAULA

I think I know what Eddie is
saying, Derek. It sounds like
you're talking about... getting
raped... at church.

DEREK

(nervous laughter)

What are you-- Come on, guys. It's
a metaphor for the-

MARK

Holy shit, Derek. Did Father
Tillman rape you?

(CONTINUED)

DEREK
Rape... is a very strong word.

EDWARD
You let him fuck you?

DEREK
I *allowed him* to help me be more comfortable with the teachings-

MARK
Dude, you got raped.

DEREK
This is about a follower and his Shepard! You three obviously aren't that deep into spirituality.

MARK
Not as deep as Father Tillman's dick was into your rectum.

DEREK
Hey, don't talk that way about Father Tillman! He's a complex man.

EDWARD
So are you, Derek.

DEREK
(breaks down)
OK! Fine. He fucked me! OK? All the songs are about him! He fucked my little 8 year old ass and it hurt. It really hurt. He tugged my balls and bit me on the cheek. I still have nightmares and wake up with a confused boner!

Derek cries.

EDWARD
Jeez, man. I had no idea.

MARK
Yeah, sorry dude. That's fucked up.

DEREK
(wiping away tears)
Yeah, well, I guess it could be a lot worse. At least I'm not attracted to my dad anymore.

(CONTINUED)

EDWARD

Yeah... You know what you need,
Derek. Mushrooms.

DEREK

Drugs?! But drugs make Jesus cry!

EDWARD

Yeah but they can also help you
work through complicated feelings.
How about this. Amy's dad has a
cabin upstate. Let's all go up
there for the weekend, take
mushrooms, then and come back on
Sunday in time for the gig.

MARK

Are you sure that's a good idea?

PAULA

Yeah, maybe Derek should try some
talk therapy first.

DEREK

No! I want to do this.

EDWARD

OK cool. I'll text Amy.

INT. CABIN - NIGHT

The band and AMY sit on the floor in a circle, except Derek
who is peering out of the window.

EDWARD

OK, everyone ready? We should each
have enough for today and tomorrow.
Derek, you might to start with a
half a dose and wait 40 minutes
then-

Derek turns to them, a crazed look in his eye.

DEREK

I took it all!

CUT TO:

INT. TRIP SEQUENCE - NIGHT

Derek sees visions and memories of Father Tillman, Jesus, God, Satan, Amy, the band, and a lot of naked men.

CUT TO:

INT. EASTER SOCIAL - DAY

Happy people socialize in their Sunday best. A small audience waits before a darkened stage. The pleasant atmosphere is cut by smoke and the sounds of feedback.

Edward, Mark, and Paula, dressed in black, are on stage.

DEREK (O.S.)
Are you ready, North Bergen!?

Unsure, the timid crowd politely applaud.

The song begins and Derek suddenly walks on stage dressed like Marilyn Manson in his prime. He screams like a monster and cuts his chest with a shard of glass. He smears the blood on his face, licks it, and points at someone in the audience.

Father Tillman slumps in his seat looking horrified.

CUT TO: CREDITS